

A hat topped with ostrich feathers was the height of fashion

Clay pipes were introduced to England from the Americas in 1586

SCENTS FOR THE SENSITIVE
Nobody was more sensitive to the stench of London than the fashionable nobility. Rich women swung their jeweled pomanders in front of them as they walked.

Gentlemen filled the air around them with tobacco smoke, hoping that it would protect them from the plague.



The skeletons in this engraving symbolize the plague

RUNNING AWAY

In 1592, everyone who was able to fled from London. Unfortunately, the plague followed them. Touring companies of actors may have helped to spread the plague. By 1593, the disease had struck other towns and cities in the country, including Shrewsbury, Nottingham, Lichfield, Derby, Leicester, and Lincoln.



STRANGE CURES

There were no effective treatments for the plague, but apothecaries, who were a cross between pharmacists and doctors, made up medicines to sell. They stored oils, herbs, and all kinds of other ingredients for their cures in pottery medicine jars.

In *Romeo and Juliet*, Shakespeare describes an apothecary's shop, full of strange things, such as "skins of ill-shaped fishes" and "musty seeds."

The pomander hung on a chain around the woman's waist

A gallant (fashionable man) with a noblewoman